

The River Answers Back: The Bridge Forward

河流的回应：通向下一程

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The eighth arc closed with a **balance** sheet that fitted on one page. An **adult** reader, a **rich outsider**, and a **southern environmentalist** sat on the board of the new station: three people, four directions, and a **compass** that pointed at the **northwestern** corner of the map.

The **northern** and **eastern** factories had agreed to a **compromise** on **pollution**: a **rubber** seal on every pipe, a **knife** by the fence for the sampling bags, and a **bare strip of ground** along the bank. “**Basically**, we **consume** the river and we call it industry,” the director said. “That is the **monster** we built.”

The **statue** in the square was of a **fairy with** a **lily**, and beside it stood an **ambitious** plan for a **planetary** park. “A **burger** and a **hay** field are not the same purchase,” the **eastern** member said, and the **outsider** agreed. “A **poison** is a **poison**, wherever it is poured.”

The **southeastern** and **southwestern** members wanted a **halfway** solution; the **northeastern** and **northwest** members wanted a full one. A **pen**, a **buck**, and a **millionaire's** promise: the board had the materials for a **compromise**, and none of them for a clean decision.

The **foremost** question was who would own the readings after the project ended. “**Mankind** does not own a river,” the **environmentalist** said. “It only rents the right to drink from it.” The board adopted a **declarative** sentence with a **hyphen** in the middle: community-owned, publicly-read.

The loss of the old scheme was easier to accept than the board had expected. Against the advice of the plant managers, the members agreed to publish ten years of data with only a side note about the cost. A **millionaire** and a **billionaire** could not fill the gap that an **ox** and an animal in the field had left. The **southeast** and the **northeast** wanted even more; the red look on the director's face said the scheme was losing. “Do not **contaminate** the well,” the **outsider** said. The **hay**, the **lily**, and the **fairy** were decoration; the **balance** sheet was the only document that mattered. Ten trees, one plant, and a board of four: the **compromise** was thin. A republican member joined the board and asked for a written rule. The river had answered every question they asked it and none of the ones they avoided.

中文翻译

第八段弧线以一份能装进一页纸的平衡表收尾。一位成年读者、一位富有的外来者，以及一位南方的环保人士坐在新站的董事会里：三个人、四个方向，以及一只指向地图西北角的指南针。

北方和东方的工厂就污染达成了一项妥协：每根管子上一个橡胶密封、栅栏边一把用来装采样袋的刀，以及岸边一条裸露的地带。“基本上，我们消耗这条河，然后称之为工业，”主管说，“那就是我们造出的怪物。”

广场上的雕像是位带百合的仙女，旁边立着一个关于行星公园的雄心方案。“一个汉堡和一片干草田不是同一笔采购，”东方成员说，而那位外来者同意了。“毒药就是毒药，倒在哪里都一样。”

东南和西南的成员想要一个折中方案；东北和西北的成员想要一个彻底的方案。一支钢笔、一块钱，以及一位百万富翁的承诺：董事会拥有了妥协的材料，却没有一个能做出干净决定的材料。

首要的问题是项目结束后这些读数归谁所有。“人类并不拥有河流，”环保人士说，“它只是租用了从中饮水的权利。”董事会通过了一句带连字符的陈述句：社区所有、公开可读。

旧方案的损失比董事会预想的更容易接受。不顾工厂经理们的反对，成员们同意公开十年的数据，只加一条关于成本的旁注。一位百万富翁和一位亿万富翁填不上田里那头牛和那只动物留下的空缺。东南和东北想要更多；主管脸上那副红涨的神情说明这个方案正在输。“不要污染那口井，”外来者说。干草、百合和仙女只是装饰；平衡表才是唯一要紧的文件。十棵树、一个厂，以及一个四人董事会：这个妥协很薄。一位共和派成员加入了董事会，并要求一条成文的规则。这条河回答了他们问它的每一个问题，却没有回答任何一个他们回避的问题。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
adult 'ædʌlt POS: n	n. 成人, 成虫; a. 成年的, 成熟的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fully developed person from maturity onward; n. any mature animal; s. (of animals) fully developed
rich ri:tʃ POS: a	a. 富裕的, 富饶的, 浓厚的, 贵重的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. possessing material wealth; a. having an abundant supply of desirable qualities or substances (especially n...)
southern 'saʊðən POS: n	n. 南方人, 男风; a. 向南方的, 来自南方的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. in or characteristic of a region of the United States south of (approximately) the Mason-Dixon line; a. sit...
balance 'bæləns POS: n	n. 平衡, 差额; vi. 平衡, 相等; vt. 称, 权衡, 比较, 使平衡, 结算, 抵消 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of equilibrium; n. equality between the totals of the credit and debit sides of an account; n. equal...
northern 'nɔ:ðən POS: n	n. 北方人; a. 北方的, 向北的, 自北方来的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a dialect of Middle English that developed into Scottish Lallans; a. in or characteristic of a region of th...
eastern 'i:stən POS: n	n. 东方人, 东正教徒; a. 东方的, 向东的, 自东的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lying toward or situated in the east; a. of or characteristic of eastern regions of the United States; a. re...
factory 'fæktəri POS: n	n. 工厂, 产地, 代理店; [经] 工厂, 代理店, 商行在国外的代理处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a plant consisting of one or more buildings with facilities for manufacturing
basically 'beisikli POS: adv	adv. 基本上, 主要地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in essence; at bottom or by one's (or its) very nature
pollution pə'lu:ʃən POS: n	n. 污染, 玷污; [化] 污染 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. undesirable state of the natural environment being contaminated with harmful substances as a consequence o...
knife naif POS: n	n. 小刀, 匕首; vt. 切割, 伤害, 切, 戳; vi. 劈开, 穿过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. edge tool used as a cutting instrument; has a pointed blade with a sharp edge and a handle; n. a weapon wit...
buck bʌk POS: n	n. 元, 雄鹿, 纨绔子弟, 鞍马, 培克(赌博时的庄家标志), 碱水, 自夸, 谈话; vi. 马背突然拱起, 反对, 吹牛, 闲聊; v... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States author whose novels drew on her experiences as a missionary in China (1892-1973); n. mature m...
consume kən'sju:m POS: vt	vt. 消耗, 消费, 消灭; vi. 耗尽, 毁灭 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. serve oneself to, or consume regularly; v. spend extravagantly; v. destroy completely; v. use up (resources o...
pen pen POS: n	n. 钢笔, 笔, 笔调, 笔杆子, 作家, 围栏, 栅栏, 禽畜; vt. 写, 关入栏中, 囚禁; vi. 动笔, 写作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a writing implement with a point from which ink flows; n. an enclosure for confining livestock; n. female sw...
bare beə POS: a	a. 赤裸的, 缺少的, 无遮蔽的, 坦率的; vt. 使赤裸, 露出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. lay bare; s. completely unclothed; s. lacking in amplitude or quantity; a. lacking its natural or customary c...
northwest 'nɔ:θwest POS: n	n. 西北, 西北部; a. 西北的, 在西北的, 来自西北的; adv. 向西北 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the northwestern region of the United States; n. the direction corresponding to the northwestward compass p...
monster 'mɒnstə POS: n	n. 怪物, 恶人, 巨物; [医] 畸胎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an imaginary creature usually having various human and animal parts; n. a cruel wicked and inhuman person; n...
compromise 'kɒmpromaɪz POS: n	n. 妥协, 折中, 折中方案, 和解; vi. 妥协处理; vt. 危害 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a middle way between two extremes; n. an accommodation in which both sides make concessions; v. make a compr...
southeast sauθ'i:st POS: n	n. 东南, 东南地区; a. 东南的, 向东南的, 来自东南的; adv. 往东南, 来自东南 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the compass point midway between south and east; at 135 degrees; n. the southeastern region of the United S...
statue 'stætʃu POS: vt	vt. 以雕像装饰; n. 雕像 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sculpture representing a human or animal
northeast 'nɔ:θ'i:st POS: n	n. 东北; a. 东北的, 向东北的, 来自东北的; adv. 向东北, 来自东北 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the compass point midway between north and east; at 45 degrees; n. the northeastern region of the United St...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
ambitious æm'biʃəs POS: a	a. 有野心的, 抱负不凡的, 雄心勃勃的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having a strong desire for success or achievement; s. requiring full use of your abilities or resources
outsider 'aut'saɪdə POS: n	n. 外人, 局外人, 非会员, 外行, 门外汉, 比赛中获胜可能性不大的选手; [经] 外船公司 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a contestant (human or animal) not considered to have a good chance to win
halfway 'hɑ:fwei POS: a	a. 中途的, 不彻底的, 部分的; adv. 半路地, 在中途, 在半途 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. at a point midway between two extremes; s. including only half or a portion; r. at half the distance; at the...
lily 'lɪli POS: n	n. 百合, 百合花; a. 洁白的, 纯白色的, 纯洁的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any liliaceous plant of the genus <i>Lilium</i> having showy pendulous flowers
rubber 'rʌbə POS: n	n. 橡皮, 橡胶, 做摩擦动作的人, 按摩师, 决胜盘; vt. 用橡胶制造, 涂橡胶于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an elastic material obtained from the latex sap of trees (especially trees of the genera <i>Hevea</i> and <i>Ficus</i>)...
environmentalist in,vaɪərən'mentlist POS: n	n. 环保人士 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who works to protect the environment from destruction or pollution
poison 'pɔɪzn POS: n	n. 毒药, 毒, 毒物, 有毒害的事物; vt. 毒害, 毒杀, 使中毒; vi. 放毒, 下毒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any substance that causes injury or illness or death of a living organism; n. anything that harms or destro...
fairy 'feəri POS: n	n. 仙女, 精灵; a. 仙女的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small being, human in form, playful and having magical powers
foremost 'fəʊməʊst POS: a	a. 最初的, 最重要的; adv. 在最前 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. preceding all others in spatial position; s. situated closest to the bow; r. prominently forward
northwestern .nɔ:θ'westən POS: a	a. 在西北部的, 西北方的, 来自西北的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. situated in or oriented toward the northwest; s. of a region of the United States generally including Washi...
mankind mæn'kaɪnd POS: n	n. 人类, 男性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n all of the living human inhabitants of the earth
hay hei POS: n	n. 干草; vt. 制干草, 供给干草; vi. 晒干草 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. grass mowed and cured for use as fodder; v. convert (plant material) into hay
southeastern sauθ'i:stən POS: a	a. 东南方的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. of a region of the United States generally including Alabama; Georgia; Florida; Tennessee; South Carolina;...
millionaire 'mɪljə'neə POS: n	n. 百万富翁, 大富豪; [经] 大资本家, 巨富, 百万富翁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person whose material wealth is valued at more than a million dollars
planetary 'plænɪtri POS: a	a. 行星的, 流浪的, 迁移不定的, 地球上的, 现世的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or characteristic of the planet Earth or its inhabitants
compass 'kæmpəs POS: n	n. 指南针, 范围, 音域; vt. 包围, 达到, 图谋, 理解 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. navigational instrument for finding directions; n. the limit of capability; n. drafting instrument used for...
burger 'bɜ:gə POS: n	n. 汉堡包 (等于hamburger) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States jurist appointed chief justice of the United States Supreme Court by Richard Nixon (1907-199...
contaminate kən'tæmineɪt POS: vt	vt. 弄污, 弄脏, 污染, 毒害; [化] 污染 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make radioactive by adding radioactive material
southwestern sauθ'westən POS: a	a. 西南的, 向西南的, 来自西南的, 西南部的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a dialect of Middle English; s. of a region of the United States generally including New Mexico; Arizona; T...
northeastern .nɔ:θ'i:stən POS: a	a. 东北方的, 在东北的, 来自东北的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. situated in or oriented toward the northeast; s. of a region of the United States generally including the N...
billionaire 'bɪljə'neə POS: n	n. 亿万富翁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a very rich person whose material wealth is valued at more than a billion dollars
ox ɒks POS: n	n. 牛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adult castrated bull of the genus <i>Bos</i> ; especially <i>Bos taurus</i> ; n. any of various wild bovines especially...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
declarative di'klæreɪtɪv POS: a	a. 宣言的, 陈述的, 说明的, 公告的; [计] 说明的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to the use of or having the nature of a declaration
hyphen 'haɪfən POS: n	n. 连字符; vt. 用连字符连接 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a punctuation mark (–) used between parts of a compound word or between the syllables of a word when the w...